TERMS & CONDITIONS

HUMAN BEHAVIOUR AT TOURIST PLACES

CONTEXT

This study investigates human behavioural patterns within different tourist contexts, observing how visitors interact with space, infrastructure, information systems, and other people. To examine how context influences behaviour, four prominent tourist sites in Gujarat were selected: Kankaria Lake, Indroda Nature Park, Dandi Kutir, and Adalaj Stepwell. Each of these locations represents a distinct tourist context such as recreational space, nature park, museum environment, and historical heritage site.

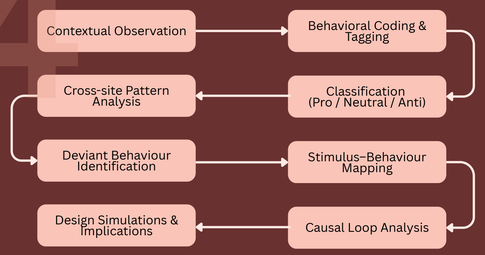
OBJECTIVES

1. To understand visitor behaviour within different tourist contexts by observing how people interact with space, infrastructure, and other visitors across selected sites.
2. To identify and analyse behavioural patterns and deviations that emerge within tourist environments, revealing how contextual expectations influence visitor actions.
3. To compare behavioural dynamics across diverse tourist settings, including Kankaria Lake, Indroda Nature Park, Dandi Kutir, and Adalaj Stepwell, to understand how spatial and cultural contexts shape visitor behaviour.
4. To identify behavioural gaps within the visitor experience, particularly where visitor actions diverge from the intended engagement with the site.
5. To derive insights that inform design interventions and simulations, addressing the identified gaps to improve the overall visitor experience within informative tourist spaces.

KEYWORDS

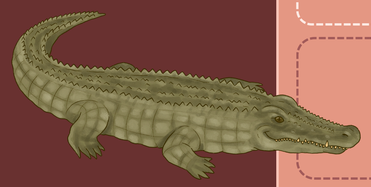
Tourist Behaviour Analysis | Visitor Engagement | Information Consumption Behavior | Spatial Behaviour | Crowd Dynamics | Attention Economy | Behavioural Mapping | Visitor Experience Design.

METHODOLOGY



GUIDED BY-
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376 OBSERVATIONS (RAW DATA) from 4 Tourist Spaces

214 Anti Behaviours identified using reference baseline (Pro / Neutral / Anti)

PATTERN RECOGNITION Recurring behavioural tendencies identified through qualitative analysis

BEHAVIOUR CLUSTERS 3 Deviant Behaviour Groups
- Risk Normalization
- Photo Documentation
- Information Ignorance

OBSERVED BEHAVIORAL PATTERNS

Authority presence enforced intended behaviour
Consciousness among visitors increased in the presence of authority, influencing positive engagement with the exibit

Spectacle Dominates Attention
Visually intense or dramatic attractions attracted the most visitors. Quieter or informational zones received less attention.

Experience as Performance
Photography and social media documentation shaped visitor behaviour. Spaces often became backdrops for capturing moments.

Risk Normalization in Public Leisure Spaces
Visitors often underestimated risks within recreational settings. Familiarity with the environment reduced cautious behaviour.









Spatial Engagement Varies by Demographics
Engagement differed across age groups and visitor types. Social roles and demographics shaped how spaces were experience.

Short Attention and Rapid Spatial Turnover
Most visitors spent very little time at individual points. Movement prioritized covering more attractions over deeper exploration.

Herd Driven Navigation
Visitor movement was largely influenced by surrounding crowds. Groups often followed collective flow rather than signage.

Information Ignorance as a Systemic Pattern
Informational panels and educational content were frequently overlooked. Visitors preferred quick visual scanning over reading.

Social Hierarchies Visible in Movement
Family roles and social structures influenced how groups moved and interacted. Leadership, care, and decision making followed visible hierarchies.

Time-Based Behaviour Changes
Behaviour shift according to duration and fatigue factor, leading to fluctuation in information intake or engagement with the exhibit in any way.

DEVIANT BEHAVIOR MAPPING

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OPPORTUNITY AREA

1
Redesigning Information Systems for better Consumption
Redesign informational content to be visual, concise, and easy to grasp within short attention spans.

2
Integrating Documentation with Information
Use tourists' photography behaviour to embed and communicate information through photo friendly touchpoints.

3
Behaviour Guided Spatial Design
Create safe viewpoints and spatial cues that guide visitors while reducing risk taking behaviour.

PROBLEM STATEMENT

Highly informative tourist sites aim to educate visitors through signage and exhibits, yet tourists often prioritize movement, visual attractions, and photography over engaging with informational content. This creates a gap between the intended educational value of these spaces and the way visitors actually experience them. The challenge is to enhance information consumption without disrupting natural visitor behaviour.

STORYTELLING AS A FORM OF INFORMATION TRANSFER

Storytelling enhances information intake by presenting facts within a narrative that is easier for people to follow, remember, and emotionally connect with. Instead of processing isolated pieces of information, visitors experience the content as a sequence of events, characters, or journeys, which naturally sustains attention and improves retention.
In tourist environments, storytelling can transform static informational content into engaging experiences. By structuring information as narratives, visitors are more likely to pause, explore, and understand the significance of the place rather than simply passing through it.





DESIGN SIMULATIONS

TOURIST SPOT HIERARCHY

- **High Information Zones**
- Partial Information Zones
- Low Information Zones
- No Information Zones

INFORMATION IGNORANCE
- Intentional
- Different Purpose
- No reward

INFORMATION ENGAGEMENT
- Potential Reader
- Purposeful
- Will Convert if Rewarded

INFORMATION CONSUMPTION
- Always consumes info
- Highly Purposeful
- Knowledge is reward

AUDIENCE	PRE INTERVENTION	SIMULATION	METHOD & PURPOSE	BEHAVIOUR TRIGGERED	POST INTERVENTION
DESIGN STUDENTS TOTAL STRENGTH **200** approx	Spot with Max Engagement (SHELDON) / Spot with Medium Engagement (SDM Lawn)	SIMULATION **1** Visual Data Intervention	**METHOD:** Informational graphics were introduced to make information visually noticeable within the space. **PURPOSE:** To test whether visual prominence of information increases visitor attention and engagement.	ATTENTION	47% NOTICING 21.4% ENGAGING
	Known spot converted into visible attraction (MAX ENGAGEMENT ENTRY POINTS - HOSTEL & MAIN GATE)	SIMULATION **2** Curiosity driven Visual Based Storytelling	**METHOD:** Short storytelling facts were attached to trees using ribbons and simple visual markers to trigger curiosity. **PURPOSE:** To test whether curiosity-driven storytelling prompts visitors to actively seek and consume information.	CURIOSITY	54.5% NOTICING 26.8% ENGAGING
INDRODA VISITORS (Crowd Group - Families, friend groups, school groups)	**EXISTING SIGNAGE/ INFORMATION** PASSIVE SIGNAGE LOW ENGAGEMENT INFORMATION IGNORANCE RATIO **VISITORS OF TOURIST SPACE** 20% NOTICING INFO 15% ENGAGING	SIMULATION 3 Auditory Storytelling	**METHOD:** Pre-recorded dinosaur stories with sound effects were played during a guided walk using a portable speaker. **PURPOSE:** To examine whether auditory narration improves information attention and retention.	INFO CONSUMPTION	90% NOTICING 48% ENGAGING
				ATTENTION SPAN	48% FULL TIME 52% DROP OFF
				SPACIAL ENGAGEMENT	86% ENGAGEMENT 44% RETENTION

KEY INSIGHTS

1 Information competes with leisure priorities in recreational spaces.

2 Visibility alone does not guarantee engagement.

3 Curiosity acts as a behavioural trigger for information engagement.

4 Sensory stimulation increases cognitive attention.

5 Information engagement depends on delivery, not availability.

6 Information engagement is a highly "itentional" behaviour

7 Herd behaviour is the biggest stimuli in any context, irrespective of the trigger.

8 Cogntive Overload reduces grasping tendency in any context. It can vary demographically.

DESIGN IMPLICATIONS

1. Strategic Visibility within Visitor Movement
Information should be positioned within the natural line of sight and movement flow of visitors, particularly at pause points and transition zones. Rather than being placed in peripheral or passive locations, information must be intentionally integrated into navigation paths so that it becomes difficult to overlook. Strategic placement ensures that visitors encounter information naturally as part of their spatial journey.

2. Glance-Friendly and Layered Information Design
Visitors in public spaces rarely engage in prolonged reading. Therefore, information should be visually striking yet cognitively light, designed for quick scanning rather than deep reading. Content should be structured into layered, bite-sized modules, allowing visitors to move from headline insights to deeper information progressively, supporting natural skim-to-engage behaviour.

3. Multi-Sensory Information Systems (Audio + Visual)
In open and high-distraction environments, static signage alone often fails to capture attention. Audio storytelling can act as a primary attention trigger, while visual information reinforces comprehension. Synchronising audio cues with nearby visual elements creates multi-sensory redundancy, improving engagement, recall, and comprehension.

4. Social and Curiosity-Driven Engagement
Visitor behaviour is strongly influenced by curiosity and social cues. Designing exhibits that create moments of intrigue, discovery, or spectacle encourages visitors to pause and explore. When engagement becomes visible and repeatable within the space, it triggers herd behaviour where others follow the same interaction patterns, increasing collective participation.

5. Spatial Storytelling and Immersive Information Environments
Information should not exist as isolated boards but as part of a larger spatial narrative. Environmental cues such as landscape transitions, thematic zoning, markers, and contextual storytelling can transform the space into an immersive learning environment. In this approach, information becomes embedded within the experience of the space rather than functioning as separate instructional content.

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